Rachel Porter

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APPOINTMENTS

University *of* Notre Dame

Notre Dame du Lac Endowed Assistant Professor 2024 –

Assistant Professor, Political Science 2022 –

Computational Social Science Fellow, Lucy Institute for Data & Society 2022 –

EDUCATION

The University *of* North Carolina *at* Chapel Hill

Ph.D., Political Science 2022

Fields: American Politics & Political Methodology

Dissertation: *Some Politics Are Still Local: Strategic Position Taking in Congress & Elections*

- Winner of the 2023 APSA E.E. Schattschneider Award

M.A., Political Science

The University *of* Georgia

B.A., Political Science & International Affairs 2016

- Phi Beta Kappa, Summa Cum Laude

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

* = GRADUATE STUDENT COAUTHOR

[10] Colin R. Case and Rachel Porter. 2026. Strategic Heterogeneity in Issue Positioning: Evidence from Congressional Campaigns. **The American Journal of Political Science**. Conditionally Accepted Pending Replication.

[9] Rachel Porter, Jeffrey J. Harden, and Mackenzie R. Dobson*. 2025. Electing amateur politicians reduces cross-party collaboration. **Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences.**

- Coverage from The New York Times, The Conversation, and Bloomberg Law

[8] Colin R. Case and Rachel Porter. 2025. Conceptualizing and measuring early campaign fundraising in U.S. elections. **Political Science Research & Methods.**

[7] Rachel Porter, Colin R. Case, and Sarah A. Treul. 2025. CampaignView, a database of policy platforms and biographical narratives for congressional candidates. **Nature: Scientific Data.**

[6] Rachel Porter, Jeffrey J. Harden, Emily Anderson*, Mackenzie R. Dobson*, Abigail Hemmen*, Géssica de Freitas*, and Emma Schroeder*. 2025. The Consequences of Elite Action Against Elections. **The British Journal of Political Science.**

[5] Rachel Porter and Sarah A. Treul. 2025. Evaluating (in)experience in congressional elections. **The American Journal of Political Science**.

- Top 10 most-cited article in AJPS, 2025
- Coverage from Brookings, Vox, FiveThirtyEight, ABC News, and the Politics in Question podcast

[4] Rachel Porter, Sarah A. Treul, and Maura McDonald. 2024. Changing the Dialogue: Descriptive Candidacies and Position Taking in Campaigns for the US House of Representatives. **The Journal of Politics.**

[3] Rachel Porter and Tyler Steelman. 2023. No Experience Required: Early Donations and Amateur Success in Congressional Primaries. **Legislative Studies Quarterly**.

- Top 10 most-cited article in LSQ, 2024

[2] Christina Ladam, Austin Bussing, Alexander Furnas, Josh McCrain, David Miller, and Rachel Porter. 2022. Junior Americanist Workshop Series. **PS: Political Science & Politics**.

[1] Maura McDonald, Rachel Porter, and Sarah A. Treul. 2020. Running as a Woman? Gender and the 2018 Congressional Election. **Political Research Quarterly**.

BOOK

[1] Colin R. Case and Rachel Porter. *Latent Measurement from Text Data: Principles and Practices for Unsupervised and Weakly-Supervised Methods.* **Cambridge University Press,** Elements in Quantitative and Computational Methods in Social Sciences (Under Contract)

BOOK CHAPTERS

[2] Jamie L. Carson, Jason M. Roberts, and Rachel Porter. 2020. "The Nationalization of Congressional Elections" in *New Directions in Congressional Politics*, Routledge.

[1] Michael S. Lynch, Anthony J. Madonna, and Rachel Surminsky. 2016. "Irregular Order: Examining the Changing Congressional Amending Process" in *Party and Procedure in the United States Congress*, Rowman & Littlefield.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Under Review

Colin R. Case, Emily C. Ommundsen, and Rachel Porter. Bipartisan Campaign Messages are Credible Signals of Bipartisan Lawmaking. **Invitation to Revise and Resubmit at *The Journal of Politics***

Jeffrey J. Harden and Rachel Porter. Information Limits in Quantitative Research.

Rachel Porter, Ben Francis* and William Kakenmaster*. When Climate Hits Home: Local Pressures and Pro-Environmentalism.

In Progress

Pamela Ban, Jaclyn Kaslovsky, and Rachel Porter. Elitism and Legislative Interaction.

Amy Brooke Grauley* and Rachel Porter. Identity-Linked Extremity: Candidate Positioning and Voter Inference in Congressional Elections.

Rachel Porter. *Some Politics is Still Local: How District Representation Persists in Nationalized Politics*. (Book manuscript)

Rachel Porter and Sarah A. Treul. *The Amateur Advantage: Unpacking the Rise of Political Inexperience in Congress & Elections* (Book manuscript)

OPEN DATA

CampaignView: U.S. House Campaign Website Archive (2018-2024)
`https://campaignview.org`

Early Fundraising in U.S. Congressional Elections (2008-2020)
`https://dataverse.harvard.edu/dataset.xhtml?persistentId=doi:10.7910/DVN/FVLHCX`

U.S. House Candidate Biographical Data & Primary Election Outcomes (1980-2024)
`https://dataverse.harvard.edu/dataset.xhtml?persistentId=doi:10.7910/DVN/CYFIDH`

PUBLIC WRITING

Rachel Porter and Jeffrey J. Harden. 3 November, 2025. "Amateur hour in Congress: How political newcomers fuel gridlock and government shutdowns." *The Conversation*.

Rachel Porter and Sarah Treul. 22 April, 2024. "Evaluating (in)experience in congressional elections." *American Journal of Political Science - Author Summaries*.

Sarah Treul and Rachel Porter. 20 April, 2018. "Inexperienced candidates are becoming more common, but only in one party." *Mischiefs of Faction - Vox*

Rachel Surminsky and Michael S. Lynch. 20 November, 2014. "When Congress sues the president, it's likely to fail." *The Monkey Cage - Washington Post*

GRANTS & AWARDS

Awards & Honors

Recognition for a top 10 most-cited article, American Journal of Political Science	2026
Recognition for a top 10 most-cited article, Legislative Studies Quarterly	2025
Notre Dame du Lac Assistant Professorship, University of Notre Dame	2024
E.E. Schattschneider Award for best dissertation in American politics, APSA	2023
Earle Wallace Award for Graduate Student Teaching, UNC Political Science	2019
Phi Beta Kappa Society, University of Georgia	2016

External Funding

Unite America Elections Reform Grant. Expanding CampaignView for 2026. 2025
Total Award: **$36,407**

Center for Effective Lawmaking Small Grant. Bipartisan Messaging in Elections. 2024
Co-PI with Colin R. Case and Emily Cottle Ommundsen
Total Award: **$1,000**

Unite America Elections Reform Grant. Measuring Issue Polarization. 2024
Co-PI with Colin R. Case
Total Award: **$21,745**

APSA Centennial Research Grant. JAWS CwC at MPSA. 2022
Co-PI with Austin Bussing, Leah Christiani, Alexander Furnas, Christina Ladam, Josh McCrain, and David Miller
Total Award: **$10,000**

Social Science Research Council Social Data Dissertation Fellowship. 2020
Total Award: **$15,000**

Internal Funding

Notre Dame Franco Institute Small Grant. **$4,000**	2026
Notre Dame Democracy Initiative Grant. **$25,000** *Co-PI with James M. Curry and Jeffrey J. Harden*	2025
Notre Dame ISLA International Travel Grant. **$1,000**	2024
UNC Graduate School Dissertation Completion Fellowship. **$20,500**	2021
UNC Political Science Hughes Summer Research Award. **$2,000**	2020
UNC Political Science Darlene Walker Summer Research Award. **$3,000**	2019
UNC Political Science, Thomas M. Ulhman Fellowship. **$5,000**/year	2016-2021
UNC Political Science, Summer Research Fellowship. **$3,000**/year	2016-2021

TEACHING

University of Notre Dame

Instructor of Record

POLS 30005: The United States Congress	FA 2023; SP 2024; SP 2025
POLS 40811: Quantitative Political Analysis	SP 2023; SP 2024; SP 2025
POLS 60040: American Political Institutions (Graduate)	FA 2022, FA 2024, FA 2026

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Instructor of Record

POLI 281: Data in Politics I	FA 2019, SP 2020, SSII 2020, FA 2020, SSII 2021
POLI 100: Introduction to American Politics	SP 2019

Teaching Assistant

POLI 130: Introduction to Comparative Politics	FA 2018
POLI 100: Introduction to American Politics	FA 2017, SP 2018

Odum Institute for Research in Social Science

Short Course Instructor

Collecting & Analyzing Text in R	SP 2019, FA 2019, SP 2020, FA 2020, SP 2021

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Presentations

2026: Yale University (Institution for Social and Policy Studies & Center for the Study of American Politics), Massachusetts Institute of Technology (Department of Political Science), University of Wisconsin-Madison (Department of Political Science), University of Toronto (Department of Statistical Sciences), University of Notre Dame (Department of Sociology), University of Rochester (Annual Summer Conference in Applied Methods for Political Science), Michigan State University (Mid-American Conference for Race, Gender, Immigration and Ethnicity Politics), University of Iowa (Shambaugh Conference on Congressional Elections), University of Notre Dame (Keeping the Republic Conference)

2025: University of Michigan (Department of Political Science), Georgetown University (McCourt School of Public Policy), University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill (Department of Political Science), University of Kentucky (Martin School of Public Policy), University of Chicago (Harris School of Public Policy Center for Effective Governance Conference), Indiana University (Center for American Politics Conference), University of Mississippi (Barbour Study of American Politics Conference)

2024: University of California-San Diego (Department of Political Science), Harvard University (Department of Government), Princeton University (Department of Politics), Stanford University (Department of Political Science), University of Virginia (Batten School of Leadership and Public Policy), Texas A&M University (Department of Political Science), American University (Department of Government), Wesleyan University (Wesleyan Media Project 2024 Post-Election Conference), University of Virginia (Center for Effective Lawmaking Conference), University of California-Berkeley (Winter American Politics Research Meeting), Washington University in St. Louis (Stories that Win Symposium), University of Notre Dame (Keeping the Republic Conference)

2023: University of Chicago (Department of Political Science), Georgetown University (Department of Government), Women in Legislative Studies Seminar

2022: Purdue University (Department of Political Science), University of Oklahoma (Carl Albert Center Conference)

2021: University of Notre Dame (Department of Political Science), University of Utah (Department of Political Science)

2020: Washington University in St. Louis (Department of Political Science), University of Georgia (School of Political Science and International Affairs), Bowling Green State University (Department of Political Science), University of Notre Dame (Department of Political Science)

Annual Conference Presentations

MPSA	2017-2019, 2021, 2023-2026
APSA	2019-2024, 2026
PolMeth	(poster) 2018-2023; (presentation) 2025
Women in Legislative Studies Conference	2023, 2025
State Politics & Policy Annual Conference	2024
CBS-Princeton Money in Politics Conference	2024
Visions in Methodology Conference	2024
Frontiers in Money and Politics APSA Pre-Conference	2021, 2023

VOLUNTEER & SERVICE

Discipline Service

Co-Organizer, Notre Dame Chambers of Democracy Conference 2026, 2027
(*with James M. Curry and Jeffrey J. Harden*)

Co-Organizer, Shambaugh Conference on Congressional Elections 2026
(*with Colin R. Case and Sarah A. Treul*)

Co-Organizer, MPSA Primary Elections Mini-Conference 2023-2026
(*with Sarah Anderson, Dan Butler, Colin Case, and Laurel Harbridge-Yong*)

Program Committee, PolMeth Annual Conference 2025
(*organized by Emory University*)

Program Committee, Visions in Methodology (VIM) Conference 2024
(*organized by Washington University in St. Louis*)

Co-Founder & Organizer, Junior Americanist Workshop Series 2020-2024

Co-Organizer, MPSA JAWS Mini-Conference 2023
(*with Austin Bussing, Leah Christiani, Alexander Furnas, David Miller, Josh McCrain*)

Referee: *American Journal of Political Science; American Political Science Review; British Journal of Political Science; Electoral Studies;* Harvard IQSS rapidPeer Review; *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion & Parties; Political Research Quarterly; Journal of Politics; JAMA Health Forum; Journal of Political Institutions and Political Economy; Journal of Information Technology & Politics; Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics; Journal of Women, Politics & Policy; Legislative Studies Quarterly*; National Science Foundation; *Nature Human Behaviour; Policy Studies Journal; Perspectives on Politics; PNAS Nexus; Political Behavior; Political Science Research & Methods; Politics & Gender; Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences; Research & Politics; Quarterly Journal of Political Science; Social Science Quarterly*

Discussant & Panelist: American Political Science Association Annual Meeting; Frontiers of Money & Politics Pre-Conference at APSA; Copenhagen Business School Money in Politics Conference; Junior Americanist Workshop Series; Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting; Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting; Women in Legislative Studies Professional Development Seminar

Departmental Service at the University of Notre Dame

Co-Director, Representation and Politics in Legislatures Lab	2023-Present
Member, Quantitative Political Science Search Committee	2026
Field Chair, Methods	2024-2025
Member, Committee on Inclusive Teaching, Learning, and Scholarship	2023-2024
Co-Chair, Undergraduate Thesis Awards Committee	2024
Admission Committee Member, Lucy Institute Graduate Fellows Program	2023
Member, Graduate Policy Council	2022-2023

Departmental Service at the University of North Carolina-Chapel Hill

Graduate Student President, Department of Political Science	2021-2022
Program Coordinator, American Politics Working Group	2018-2020
American Field Representative, Department of Political Science	2018-2019

Undergraduate and Doctoral Student Advising

Dissertation Committee Member

Emma Schroeder (Notre Dame; Defended April 2026; Texas Christian University-TT)
Abigail Hemmen (Notre Dame; Defended April 2026; Duquesne University-TT)
Haley Cohen (Columbia University; Defended May 2025; University of Houston-TT)

Methods Paper Committee Member

Géssica de Freitas (In progress)
Adriana Pilar Ferreira Albanus (In progress)

Undergraduate Mentoring

Senior Thesis Advisor, Thomas Musgrave (Defended 2025)
Senior Thesis Advisor, Erik Johansen (Defended 2025)
Senior Thesis Co-Advisor, Julia Thomalla (Defended 2024, Best Thesis Award Winner)